



# Incident report analysis

## Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or just to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this chart as a way to continue practicing applying the NIST CSF framework to different situations you may encounter.

|          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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| Summary  | The organization experienced a security incident when user accounts began showing unauthorized login attempts from multiple international IP addresses. Shortly afterward, several employee accounts were locked due to repeated failed authentication attempts. The cybersecurity team determined that this activity was part of a coordinated credential-stuffing attack using previously exposed usernames from an external data breach. Immediate action was taken to contain the attack, secure employee accounts, and restore normal access. |
| Identify | A malicious external actor attempted to gain unauthorized access to employee accounts using automated login attempts. The scope of the incident included the organization's cloud-based authentication system, affecting both internal and remote employees. The attack targeted user credentials and threatened to compromise confidentiality and system integrity. All affected accounts needed to be secured, reviewed, and restored.                                                                                                           |
| Protect  | To reduce exposure, the cybersecurity team enforced password resets for all employees and implemented mandatory multi-factor authentication (MFA). Rate-limiting rules were applied to the authentication service to slow repeated login attempts. Additionally, the team updated password policies to require stronger passwords and restricted login attempts from high-risk geographic                                                                                                                                                          |

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|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|         | regions.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Detect  | The team used security information and event management (SIEM) alerts to monitor spikes in failed logins and identify abnormal login locations. Geo-IP filtering tools detected several unauthorized attempts originating from regions where the company does not operate. Log analysis highlighted patterns indicating automated bot activity, including rapid login attempts against multiple accounts.                                                              |
| Respond | In response to the attack, the cybersecurity team temporarily disabled accounts showing signs of compromise and blocked offending IP ranges at the firewall. They notified all employees about the incident and provided guidance on phishing awareness and password hygiene. All suspicious activity was documented and escalated to the security manager. System logs were preserved for further investigation and reporting.                                        |
| Recover | Recovery focused on restoring secure access to employee accounts and normal business operations. Compromised accounts were reset with new credentials and MFA. After confirming that login activity had stabilized and no further unauthorized attempts were detected, normal authentication services resumed. To prevent future occurrences, the organization plans to implement continuous authentication monitoring and conduct routine credential exposure checks. |

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Reflections/Notes:

- Could additional login monitoring tools help detect credential attacks earlier?

- Should the company implement password-less authentication in the future?
- Would employee security awareness training reduce the risk of credential compromise?
- How can automated alerts be improved to reduce response time?